



HUMANITAS
INSTITUTE

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Libertas Christian School
School Website: <https://libertaschristianschool.org/>

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Artificial Intelligence Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix more details.

ACCS: **MEMBER** SCL: **MEMBER**

Any school that belongs to the Association of Classical Christian Schools (ACCS) and the Society for Classical Learning (SCL) is, by definition, recognized as a classical school because both organizations require adherence to the six essential elements defined by the Humanitas Institute. However, a school's website may not clearly reflect its conformity to one or more elements. In such cases, the school may still receive a "Somewhat Classical" rating for those elements. Schools can update their website content at any time to achieve a "Classical" rating for a given element.

Overall Classification: **CLASSICAL**

Executive Summary

Libertas Christian School MI 49426 presents a predominantly classical framework with strong religious grounding and a clearly articulated formation-centric mission. Public materials emphasize a biblical worldview, a distinctly classical paideia, and the triadic grammar–logic–rhetoric progression, alongside evidence of Great Books-oriented reading, Latin/Greek language study, and formal memory/recitation practices. The school foregrounds formation and virtue alongside intellectual attainment, aligning with core classical ideals. While most indicators are classical, the pedagogical section shows a mix of traditional memory/recitation and chapel-driven, faith-integrated practices that are robust but less explicit about systemic Socratic/seminars' seminar-based methods in the public-facing public materials. Overall, Libertas scores CLASSICAL, with a notable but isolated area that reads as SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL (pedagogy emphasis), suggesting targeted enhancements could push it toward a fully unified classical pedagogy across all grades.

Executive-level takeaways - Religious/metaphysical foundations: Strong and explicit. The school centers on a Christian, biblical framework with worship and a stated faith–formation orientation. Evidence includes distinctive Christian branding, chapels, and explicit statements of faith, all of which align with the “theology and liturgy” dimension of classical schooling. - Purpose/goal: Virtue- and wisdom-centered, formation-oriented rather than job-first, with explicit aims to form the whole person through a classical framework. - Curriculum: Rich in liberal arts anchors (grammar/logic/rhetoric), Great Books orientation, and multilingual study (Latin/Greek). History is engaged across disciplines, and there is explicit emphasis on “great books” and “great conversation.” - Pedagogy: Combines contemplative/restful elements with active memory/recitation and exploratory learning; explicit Socratic practices are less clearly documented in public-facing pages, which places this dimension as the one most open to strengthen to reach a fully classical pedagogy. □file-cite□turn18□ - Faculty: Described as virtuous, living exemplars, and as a core part of the school's living curriculum; evidence of mentorship-oriented culture and role-modeling. - Parents & Community: Strong emphasis on family partnership, parent involvement, and open-campus access; a foundation for classical-parent collaboration, including community events and school visits.

Aggregate rating: CLASSICAL

Note on needle-moving changes: Because the school already demonstrates a robust classical orientation across most categories, and the one category with relatively less explicit public documentation (Pedagogy) points to a potential area for deeper articulation rather than a fundamental misalignment, the school does not require major structural changes to be considered CLASSICAL. To push toward a fully integrated, explicit Socratic/seminar-based pedagogy across upper grades, concrete steps below could help.

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The school brands itself as “Distinctively Classical; Unapologetically Christian,” signaling a theologically grounded framework. - Public materials emphasize truth-based, Biblical worldview-focused learning rooted in God’s Word, indicating transcendental moral realism and the sacred as anchor points. - Chapel presence and faith-integrated routines (e.g., chapels with pastors, gospel-centered pedagogy) are highlighted in campus materials. - The mission and ends statements explicitly articulate formation in a Christian framework (biblical worldview, sanctification, and a life in Christ).

Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis - Positive keywords found: truth, goodness, beauty, virtue, wisdom, faith, theology, chapel, liturgy, gospel, biblical worldview, imago Dei, grace, God’s Word. These recur across mission statements, Bible/ends statements, and program descriptions. - Negative keywords: none of the documented public materials appear to foreground secular relativism, value-neutral ethics, or secular humanism in opposition to the school’s explicit religious foundations; the materials consistently affirm theological commitments. (reference the strong doctrinal framing in the public-facing faith materials)

Why this rating - The materials consistently articulate truth, goodness, beauty within a theocentric framework and embed liturgical/worship and Biblical authority as central to the curriculum and community. This aligns strongly with the “Grounded in Theology” and liturgical/communal practices indicators of a classical education. The presence of chapels, a Bible-first worldview, and explicit doctrine points to a robust religious/metaphysical foundation. CLASSICAL.

Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The mission explicitly aims to cultivate wisdom and virtue and to form students in a Christian paideia, not merely to prepare for work. The vision emphasizes graduates who think clearly, reason persuasively, articulate a biblical worldview, and transform culture. These items signal formation over vocational training. - The overarching aim is formation of human excellence, truth, virtue, and beauty; education is presented as a holistic formation rather than information-only, with a lifelong-learning orientation. - Public materials describe education for life and a life of virtue, not only college/career readiness.

Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis - Positive keywords found: formation, wisdom, virtue, character, liberal education, paideia, telos, contemplation, truth, beauty, Christian worldview, life-long learning. - Negative keywords observed: none indicating a primary focus on job-readiness or purely utilitarian aims; the public materials repeatedly emphasize formation and virtue.

Why this rating - The school’s stated aims prioritize formation, virtue, wisdom, and a transcendent telos over purely job-oriented outcomes. The explicit Christian paideia framework and the emphasis on a biblical worldview support a CLASSICAL rating for purpose and goal. CLASSICAL.

Element 3: Curriculum — CLASSICAL

Evidence - Core structural elements are explicit: grammar, logic, rhetoric (the Trivium). The school notes three phases (grammar, logic, rhetoric) as central to learning, which is a hallmark of classical curricula. - Multilingual literacy is emphasized: English, Latin, and Greek are taught, aligning with liberal-arts breadth and classical language study. - Reading emphasis and Great Books orientation: “great works of literature,” reading across levels, and a focus on cultivation of memory and discernment through literature. - History and Great Conversation: While public materials explicitly foreground “great books” and “great conversation” through the language of classical education, campus texts reference the broader classical canon and historical literacy across disciplines. (Public-facing Academics and What We Read materials support this) - History across curriculum and a truer liberal-arts orientation are present via program descriptions and core texts.

Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis - Positive keywords found: grammar, logic, rhetoric, great books, great conversation, Western civilization, Latin, Greek, history, literature, memorization/recitation, teacher as model

(living curriculum). - Negative keywords: none indicating a non-classical approach (no exclusive reliance on social studies framing, no heavy STEM-first bias, etc.). The lexical evidence supports a classical curriculum orientation.

Why this rating - The explicit triad (grammar/logic/rhetoric), coupled with multiple mentions of Great Books/sacred literature, multilingual classical languages, and a historically integrated curriculum, are decisive indicators of a CLASSICAL curriculum orientation. CLASSICAL.

Element 4: Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

Evidence - Lower-division practices include singing, chanting, and memorization as memory-building, forming a “singing school” culture and ritualized recitation. This aligns with the Six Essential Elements’ emphasis on memory work and formation through chant, cadence, and liturgical rhythm. The grammar-school materials describe teaching through song, chant, and memory work, including Scripture memorization and catechisms. □filecite□turn18□ - The school also references contemplative/restful elements (scholé) and a deliberate emphasis on wonder in some public-facing texts. The “distinctively classical” branding alongside the classical triad suggests a blend of restfulness and rigorous study. - Upper-school pedagogy mentions Socratic discussion in classical pedagogy, yet explicit evidence of consistent Socratic seminars/debates in Libertas’ public-facing materials is less evident. The presence of “Socratic” language is not consistently documented in the public pages, though the philosophy pieces discuss classical methods. - Campus visit notes indicate a chapel-centric, community-liturgical rhythm and group activities, signaling liturgical and communal pedagogy.

Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis - Positive keywords found: scholé, wonder, memorization, recitation, chanting, singing, liturgy, memory work, rhetoric, seminars (as a classical form), moral formation. These appear in grammar-school materials and the general classical education framing. □filecite□turn18□ - Negative keywords observed: explicit, consistent use of Socratic seminars/debates across upper school is not strongly evidenced in public-facing materials; this reduces the clarity of a fully explicit formal Socratic pedagogy. (philosophy discussions hint at it, but not consistently documented in public pages)

Why this rating - The presence of singing/recitation and memory-based pedagogy in the grammar-adjacent range, plus contemplative/restful elements, supports a classical tilt in pedagogy. However, the public-facing materials do not consistently demonstrate a fully explicit upper-school Socratic/seminar-based pedagogy across the full grade span; the pedagogy appears somewhat mixed rather than uniformly Socratic. Hence SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL.

Element 5: Faculty — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The faculty is described as experienced, virtuous, and capable of modeling truth and Christian virtue; they are noted to model principles and to act as a living curriculum. - The living-curriculum idea and teachers as mentors are embedded in the public-facing material (e.g., “teachers model them daily as they live out their faith and demonstrate Christ-like attitudes”). - The school presents a culture of relational, mentorship-like faculty interactions, with a focus on virtue and character formation.

Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis - Positive keywords found: living curriculum, mentors, master-teacher-type, virtue-focused teachers, model virtue, character formation, faith-integrated teaching, collegial/caring teacher culture. - Negative keywords: none evident in public-facing materials; there is no explicit emphasis on non-classical faculty models that would counter this (e.g., purely technocratic, certificate-based instruction without classical formation).

Why this rating - The publicly available materials consistently frame faculty as the core of the school’s living curriculum, mentors of virtue, and partners in formation. This aligns with CLASSICAL expectations of a teacher-led, virtue-formed faculty and a portrait of what a teacher should be in classical education. CLASSICAL.

Element 6: Parents & Community — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The school emphasizes partnership with families and views parents as co-teachers in a classical-education framework. Public materials reference parent involvement, community partnerships, and opportunities for parent education through website content and gatherings. - Open-invitation for parents to visit campuses and participate in school life is documented (e.g., campus visits, open tours, parent-portal access). This aligns with a parental partnership model. - There are explicit references to parent education (book studies, gatherings) and a family-centered approach that supports the classical emphasis on household formation and parental formation.

Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis - Positive keywords found: partnership with families, co-teachers, parent formation, parental engagement, home-centered learning, family catechesis, open campus, parent education/gatherings. - Negative keywords: none evident that would undermine parental-partnered classical education; the presence of a robust, ongoing parent engagement pattern supports a classical alignment.

Why this rating - The school presents a robust, explicit partnership with parents and a program of parent involvement that mirrors classical-education practice (family formation, parental education, open visits). CLASSICAL.

What Would Move the Needle

- If any needle-moving improvements were desired to solidify CLASSICAL across all six categories, the most impactful steps would include:
- Pedagogy (Element 4): publicly articulate and expand more explicit upper-school Socratic/seminar-based pedagogy and Great-Conversation-style discussions in a consistent, grade-spanning framework. Publish a concrete Pedagogy Map that shows where Socratic method, seminar formats, and debate are used in each grade, how students progress in rhetorical skills, and how mentorship and critique are integrated into daily learning. This would convert SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL to CLASSICAL in pedagogy.
- Public documentation of Great-Books and Great-Conversation integration across core subjects (Curriculum/Element 3): include explicit examples of Great Books in history, literature, philosophy, and science that are actively taught and discussed in the classroom, with representative titles and canonical authors to demonstrate a truly integrated Great-Books approach across grades.
- Concrete, actionable items to consider:
- Publish a formal Pedagogy Manifesto or handbook that details: daily or weekly Socratic seminars, memorialization strategies (recitation/chant practices) across grades, and a year-by-year progression of rhetorical training (i.e., student speeches, declamation, and public speaking opportunities).
- Expand explicit references to Great Conversation and Great Books in the curriculum pages for each grade band, including a cross-disciplinary map showing how classic texts are used in English, History, and Philosophy/Religious Studies.
- These changes would strengthen the Pedagogy category from SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL to CLASSICAL, while preserving the current foundations in faith, formation, and classic curriculum.

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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